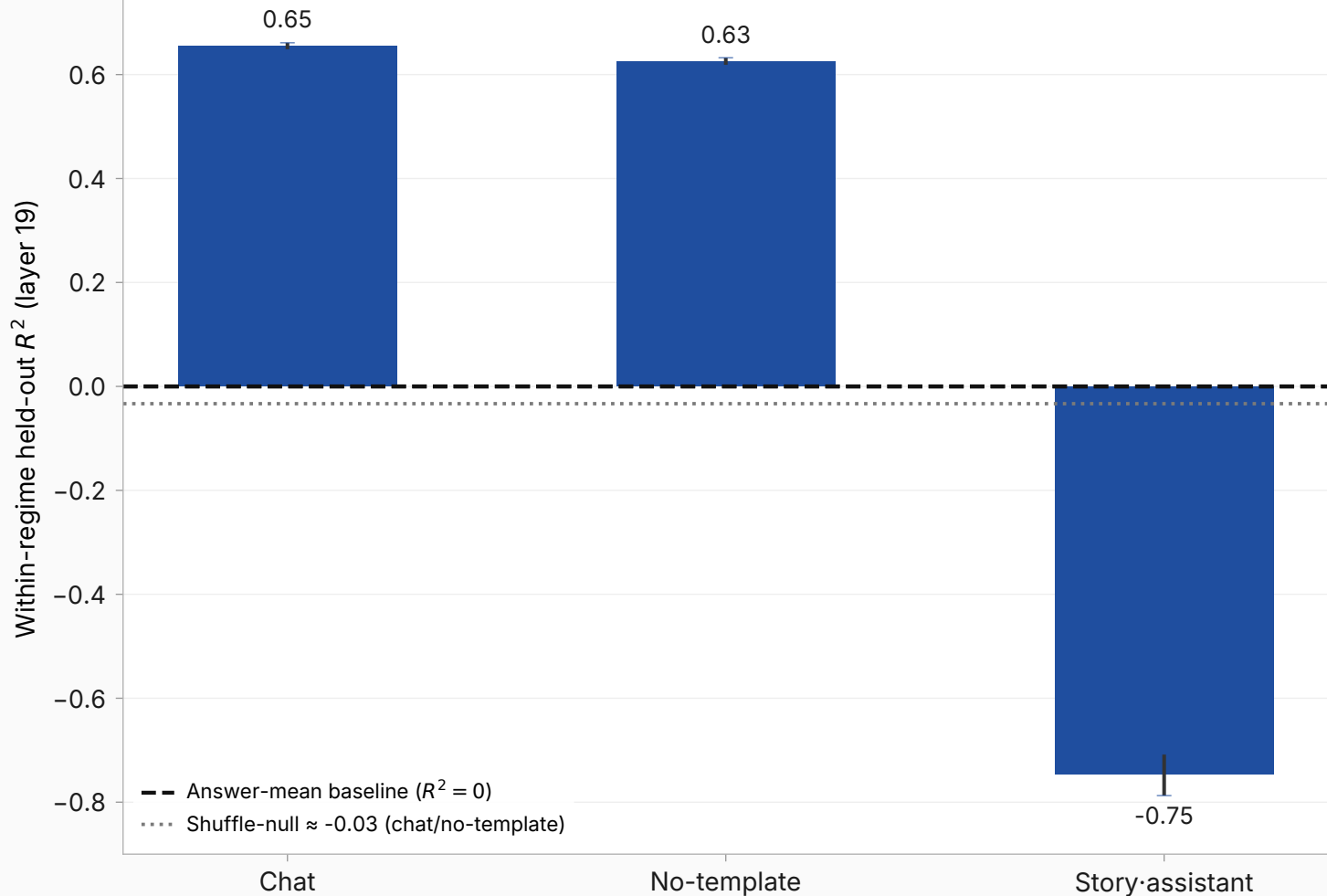


The story-character assistant map is not linearly decodable (instruct, context arm, layer 19)



Bars = within-regime held-out R^2 with 95% bootstrap CI (Qwen2.5-7B-Instruct). Chat and no-template sit ~ 0.6 (well above the answer-mean baseline); the assistant rendered as a story character sits at -0.75 , below zero — the held-out probe does worse than predicting the mean (its own shuffle-null is off-scale at ~ -2.2). Base arm omitted (its story regime was below the yield floor).